

Chapter 119-6

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Progress on set was going fairly smoothly. Yan Xi's condition was pretty good, though the person who had once confidently declared she would definitely be better than Liang Shi was long gone.

After realizing that acting was a technical skill, Yan Xi studied diligently every day, asking questions and even observing Liang Shi's acting.

One day, after filming a very plain scene, Yan Xi couldn't help but praise: "You're so amazing. I was immediately drawn into it."

Liang Shi was surprised: "Isn't this just everyday expression?"

"No, no, no." Yan Xi said: "I've been studying these past few days. Either it's climactic, explosive emotions and events—like arguments and crying scenes—or it's especially calm everyday moments where the dialogue sounds like it could come from anyone's mouth in real life. These two types are the hardest."

Liang Shi: "..."

So this was what a top student was like?

Liking to observe and summarize everything they do.

But it had to be said, Yan Xi's observations made a lot of sense.

Having climaxes and big dramatic swings stimulates the audience—it's the same principle as going to the cinema to watch an action film.

But calm everyday scenes aren't easy to act well, especially for famous actors, because audiences tend to conflate reality with the work.

And everyday scenes are all about conveying emotions, letting the audience immerse themselves and become part of the story.

It looks simple but is actually very difficult.

"And then?" Liang Shi asked her directly.

Yan Xi restrained her smile and asked seriously: "How can I make sure I am me, and the character is the character?"

Liang Shi explained from her own experience and discovered that Yan Xi was squatting while listening, not delicate at all.

Completely different from the impression she'd had when they first met.

And she was taking notes very seriously in a little notebook.

Encountering such a student, Liang Shi also taught very seriously.

When the director saw this, he had the cameraman film this scene to use as behind-the-scenes footage later.

Today they were filming together with the second unit. The second unit was filming scenes between Zhao Ying and Shu Yi—all relatively minor scenes, handled by the assistant director.

Paparazzi had brought professional equipment to stake out and photograph candid shots of Zhao Ying and Shu Yi.

But when they saw these two were also good-looking, they filmed a segment of them as well.

During this time, Yan Xi wanted to drink water but wasn't strong enough to twist open the bottle cap. Liang Shi happened to be nearby and helped twist it open.

The paparazzi captured all of this.

That night, a hashtag exploded: #["Mo Guang" Is A Publicly-Funded Romance Drama Set Right](#)^{#.1}

The paparazzi dramatically added captions, explaining the videos they'd captured that day. Zhao Ying and Shu Yi were alright—they were just joking around on set, though they did seem to have CP chemistry.²

As for Liang Shi and Yan Xi's pair, the caption directly read: Only real couples could do these things, right?

The drama itself already had decent buzz. With Zhao Ying and Shu Yi's addition, plus a director who had produced famous works before, everyone was quite looking forward to it.

Seeing Zhao Ying and Shu Yi at the front, fans got a bit riled up.

The cause was that last night, someone had photographed Yang Shuyan appearing at the "Mo Guang" set, visiting Zhao Ying. That night, they even entered the same hotel—suspected relationship exposure.

The two's fans were tearing each other apart online until the sky turned dark.

One side said some nobody wasn't worthy of their sister; the other side told some ugly thing to get lost.

On the plaza,³ any hashtag with their two names was too filthy to look at.

Passersby and melon-eating spectators⁴ who clicked in were completely confused, having no idea what had happened.

Occasionally a few rational fans would say: Won't believe it until it's officially announced.

Then a few career-focused fans were frantically promoting on the plaza. In any case, they stirred up several "explosive" hashtags.

Yet neither Zhao Ying nor Yang Shuyan responded.

Even their studios were playing dead.

In today's entertainment industry gossip, there's an unspoken rule: not denying is the same as admitting.

1. Publicly-funded romance (公费恋爱): Internet slang referring to when actors in a drama have such good chemistry that fans feel like they're watching a real romance unfold, as if the production is "publicly funding" their love story for viewers' enjoyment. ⇐
2. CP chemistry (CP感): CP stands for "couple pairing." Having "CP chemistry" means two people look like they could be a romantic couple, whether in fiction or real life. ⇐
3. Plaza (广场): Refers to the main public feed on Weibo (Chinese social media platform), similar to Twitter's timeline, where trending topics and discussions appear. ⇐
4. Melon-eating spectators (吃瓜群众): Chinese internet slang for onlookers who watch drama unfold without getting involved, similar to saying "grabbing popcorn" in English. The phrase originated from the image of people casually eating watermelon while watching events unfold. ⇐